norm. Although telesurgeries have taken place, this is one critical application that will require more reliable connections to become commonplace. Maybe after 5G rollout?

09 NAVIGATION

With the onset of cheap GPS devices, it was a no brainer to predict that all vehicles could be easily tracked in realtime through GPS in 2005. Well, this has not exactly played out, although aftermarket devices can not only locate your vehicle, but also control some on board systems if they are compatible. We did however correctly predict navigation apps that would help you find the fastest route.

Digit staff had anticipated a form factor between a phone and laptop before tablets.

10 FLEXIBLE SCREENS

It was an audacious prediction, perhaps driven by some strong marketing, but in 2005, Digit anticipated flexible screens rolling out to consumers within two years! Well, while we do have some flexible smartphones in the market, they just tend to snap more than bend. Digital paper is still a long way off, and we do not expect you to be reading Digit on such a display any time soon.

11 PERVASIVE COMPUTING

Digit had predicted that by the year 2009, we would have computing everywhere... in light bulbs, refrigerators, milk cartons, toys, vehicles and even under our skins. Well, we are getting there.

12 4G

While we correctly predicted the rapid rollout and adoption of 4G in India back in 2006, we really did not anticipate all the use cases. Back then, downloading of data was a priority as against the applications developed for 4G, which was streaming. We had predicted that users could download a CDs worth of data within a minute, considering average 4G download speeds, it takes just a bit longer.

13 PERSONALISED SEARCH

When Google first rolled out personalised search results, it was something users had to opt into, and was not turned on by default. The Digit team instantly saw the benefits of personalised search, and could not understand why more people were not using it. We had predicted a cleaner Google interface in 2007, and received it too.

14 GPUS

Digit had correctly predicted that applications would move from a reliance on CPUs to become more demanding on GPUs. Our magic crystal balls clearly showed that the photorealistic games and the high definition videos of the future would require more powerful GPUs than any available in 2007. One thing we got wrong was expecting NVidia to provide GPUs to most cell phones.

15 LAPLETS

In 2008, Digit had somewhat anticipated a device bridging the gap between mobile phones and laptop computers, but this thought had not crystalised in the form factor of a laplet. We had also imagined cell phones that could fit in your ear and be powered by your heart. We had anticipated a decade or two for this convergence, so we may still get earphones with SIM cards within that period.

16 3D PRINTING HEARTS

We had predicted in 2008 that we would be able to print hearts within two decades. The time frame for that prediction has not passed yet, but we are closer to the goal now, as we can 3D print viable tissue, and are very good at printing tubular structures, such as blood vessels. We hope this prediction comes true.

17 DVDS

Digit's predictions for disc based storage included cheap, biodegradable, paper Blu-Ray discs, discs that could store 10 TB of data and even five dimensional DVDs that could store 1.6 TB of data. While all of these were demonstrated technology products, we have fortunately done away with the medium entirely, and moved on to SSDs.

18 MOBILE CONTENT

In 2009, we had correctly predicted that mobile content would be big business in the near future, delivering movies, music, ebooks and comics on demand to consumers on the go. We had also predicted multiplayer mobile gaming, but the article focused on allowing two players in Delhi and Mumbai to come together in a game of virtual cricket or tennis - not PUBG.